PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM Engineering | Threat Detection and Response | SOC Optimisation

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) and Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience specialising in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) engineering, threat detection, security monitoring, and log management. I have deep expertise in Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL) and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, and I bring a proven track record of optimising Security Operations Centre (SOC) workflows, building high-fidelity detection rules aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, and driving SOC maturity through Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation. I am experienced in incident response under the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) 800-61 lifecycle, proactive threat hunting, and delivering measurable improvements to detection capability across large, complex enterprise environments.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Engineering and Log Management:** Microsoft Sentinel (expert KQL query authoring, detection rule development, workbook and analytics rule engineering), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Splunk with Search Processing Language (SPL); log ingestion, normalisation, and correlation engineering
- **Threat Detection and Security Monitoring:** Detection-as-code methodology, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection engineering, custom analytics rules and indicators of compromise (IOC) development, proactive threat hunting
- **SOC Optimisation and SOAR Automation:** SOAR playbook design and automation, alert triage optimisation, mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR) improvement, Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) workflow engineering
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365 (M365); 8,000-user deployment and management
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, NIST 800-61 Incident Response, MITRE ATT&CK, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Scripting:** PowerShell for security automation, KQL advanced analytics, SPL threat hunting queries

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2025 - Present*

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Lead SIEM engineering efforts across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, developing and tuning analytics rules, custom detection logic, and automated watchlists to reduce false positives and improve alert fidelity.
- Perform advanced log management and correlation engineering, onboarding new data sources, designing connector pipelines, and ensuring comprehensive log coverage across the enterprise estate.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using KQL, SPL, and MITRE ATT&CK TTPs, identifying previously undetected threats and developing new detection content from hunting findings.
- Engineer SOAR automation playbooks to streamline incident triage, automated containment, and enrichment workflows, significantly reducing mean time to respond to security incidents.
- Manage SOC monitoring and optimisation, including alert tuning, detection coverage mapping, and regular review of detection engineering backlog against emerging threat intelligence.
- Lead incident response investigations in accordance with the NIST 800-61 lifecycle, producing detailed investigation reports and post-incident improvement recommendations.
- Oversee Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) operations across 8,000 users, including advanced hunting, custom detections, and integration with Microsoft Sentinel for unified detection

and response.

- Drive vulnerability management programmes using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), aligning remediation priorities to risk appetite and CIS Controls benchmarks.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2022 - March 2025*

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Performed daily SIEM alert triage, security monitoring, and incident investigation using Microsoft Sentinel (KQL) and CrowdStrike Falcon, developing detection rules to identify and respond to threats mapped to MITRE ATT&CK.
- Contributed to SIEM engineering by designing and maintaining analytics rules, custom data connectors, and workbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to improve SOC monitoring coverage and operational efficiency.
- Executed proactive threat hunting exercises using KQL-based queries and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying indicators of compromise and lateral movement within the environment.
- Developed and maintained log management processes, ensuring consistent ingestion of Windows event logs, Azure AD sign-in logs, and network perimeter logs into Microsoft Sentinel.
- Authored PowerShell automation scripts and SOAR playbook logic to streamline incident response tasks, reducing manual analyst workload during triage.
- Responded to cyber security incidents following NIST 800-61, handling containment, eradication, and recovery activities and producing formal incident reports.
- Supported the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across 8,000 users, managing onboarding, policy enforcement, automated investigation and response (AIR), and alert management.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and AppCheck, providing detailed remediation guidance and tracking remediation progress across the organisation.

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech) *February 2021 - March 2022*

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Administered security monitoring and log management for a cloud-native SaaS and FinTech organisation, configuring SIEM log sources and managing alerting for security events across Azure-hosted infrastructure.
- Managed endpoint protection and detection controls, Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies via Microsoft Intune, and email security configuration.
- Configured Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) identity and access controls, including user provisioning, MFA enforcement, Conditional Access policies, and SSO integrations.
- Performed vulnerability assessments and contributed to ISO 27001-aligned internal security audits, supporting the organisation's risk management programme.
- Authored PowerShell scripts to automate routine security operations tasks and improve infrastructure management efficiency.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Engineered a comprehensive library of MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection rules within Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, achieving measurable improvement in detection coverage across key attack techniques and reducing analyst alert fatigue.
- Designed and deployed SOAR automation playbooks that automated tier-1 alert triage and initial containment actions, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) and freeing analyst capacity for complex investigations.
- Led the enterprise-wide deployment and integration of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Microsoft Defender for Identity across 8,000 users, delivering unified detection and response capability integrated with Microsoft Sentinel.
- Improved log management coverage by onboarding new data sources and engineering custom connectors in Microsoft Sentinel, closing detection gaps and improving SOC visibility across the estate.
- Achieved Cyber Essentials Plus certification through structured vulnerability management, driving remediation of critical and high-severity findings ahead of scheduled assessment.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Remote (Manchester/UK)